

Episode Title: "Echoes of the Past"

Season 1, Episode 1

ACT 1

FADE IN:

EXT. DARK FOREST – NIGHT

A glowing moon peeks through twisted branches. Heavy mist rolls through the woods. A cloaked woman, ELARA (pregnant), runs beside her husband, JAXON. A small, dragon-like creature, ZEPHYR, flutters beside them, eyes glowing.

ELARA

(urgent whisper)

They're close. We don't have much time.

JAXON

Just a little farther. The sanctum is near.

Suddenly — a WHIRL of SHADOWY FIGURES emerges from the trees. Leading them: MALGARETH, face hidden beneath a wizard's hood, eyes cold and cruel.

MALGARETH

You can't outrun the darkness, Elara. Hand over the artifacts.

Jaxon draws a glowing blade. Elara clutches her belly in pain.

ELARA

(nods to Zephyr)

Take her. Keep her safe. Go!

Zephyr's wings pulse. A rune on his chest glows. He nudges Elara's stomach gently... then whooshes into the sky — carrying a glowing swaddle.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. ORPHANAGE ROOM – NIGHT

RAINDROPS on the window. A teenage girl, RIYA (15), sits on her bed, solving a complex puzzle cube. A faint GLOW sparks in her hand, and the cube clicks open. Her eyes widen slightly — but she hides it as footsteps approach.

HEADMISTRESS (O.S.)

Still fiddling with that junk? You'll never be like the others.

Riya clutches the cube, her expression hardening.

EXT. AETHELBURG CITY – MORNING

A faded city. Magic glimmers faintly in streetlamps and floating signs. But it's failing. Merchants argue, guards patrol, and people murmur about a coming eclipse.

Riya walks alone through the crowded street. Kids her age whisper and point.

KID #1

That's her. The weird one with the glowing hands.

KID #2

Heard she talks to her cat like it's alive.

(Cut to Zephyr — now a cat-like creature with glowing eyes — on her shoulder, purring mockingly.)

INT. LIBRARY – DAY

Riya climbs the dusty upper levels. She pulls a hidden book — the wall CREAKS open. Inside: a secret chamber filled with old scrolls and artifacts.

She finds an old, weathered journal. The initials "E.J." on the front.

She opens it. Symbols inside glow faintly when her fingers trace them.

RIYA

(whispers)

What is this...?

She flips pages: drawings of Zephyr in dragon form. A map of underground ruins. A symbol of the Shadow Syndicate.

Suddenly: the symbol glows — and her puzzle cube begins floating.

Whispers fill the room... Riya staggers, overwhelmed.

INT. ROOFTOP – NIGHT

Riya sits under the stars with Zephyr curled beside her.

RIYA

You've always been with me... but I think there's more.

More to you.

More to me.

And I'm going to find out.

Zephyr's eyes blink. A deep voice ECHOES in Riya's mind — her first time hearing it.

ZEPHYR (V.O.)

Then we begin, little spark.

EPISODE TITLE: "Echoes of the Past"

Season 1, Episode 1
ACT 2

EXT. AETHELBURG – OLD DISTRICT – NEXT DAY

The city hums with strained magical energy. Faint glowing signs flicker overhead. Riya moves quickly through alleys, clutching the journal.

Cut to: a mural defaced with dark sigils — a forgotten tribute to the city's "missing king."

INT. ANTIQUARIAN SHOP – MOMENTS LATER

RIYA walks into a cluttered shop filled with odd relics, where she meets FINN — a curious, scruffy boy (16) repairing a broken magical compass.

RIYA

Is that a tracking rune? Who taught you that?

FINN

(pulling goggles off)

Old man Silas. Used to be an explorer before the Syndicate scared him into hiding.

(studies her)

You're not from around here, are you?

They share a brief stare-down — Finn is guarded, but intrigued. Riya shows him the journal.

RIYA

I think this belonged to my parents.

I want to know who they were. Why I have... this.

(she sparks a faint pulse of magic in her fingers)

Finn's eyes widen.

FINN

You should come with me.

INT. UNDERGROUND STUDY – LATER

They enter a secret chamber under the shop. Candles flicker. Charts, magical diagrams, and maps line the walls. An old man — SILAS — snores in a chair, then jolts awake.

SILAS

Finn, you better not be stealing—
(stops when he sees Riya)
...You have her eyes.

He steps closer, noticing the floating cube and the dragon mark glowing under her sleeve.

SILAS

The child of Elara lives...

Silas tells the story: a powerful wizard overthrew the rightful king years ago — the king's brother — and now rules in disguise. The magic of Aethelburg is fading because it's being stolen. And worse: the wizard is searching for the "Vein of Eternity," a source of magic that could raise the underworld army.

Riya's hands shake.

RIYA

My parents... they tried to stop him?

SILAS

They paid the price for their rebellion.

EXT. SHADOW SYNDICATE HALL – NIGHT

A black spire rises outside the city walls. Inside: LYRA — a beautiful woman with sharp eyes and a quiet menace — kneels before MALGARETH.

LYRA

She's found the journal.

MALGARETH

Good. Let her run. Let her gather hope.

(leans close)

And when she leads us to the artifacts... crush it.

INT. CITY RUINS – SAME NIGHT

Riya and Finn follow the journal map to the forgotten ruins beneath the city. Old glyphs line the walls. A puzzle-lock door awaits.

Zephyr — now a humanoid creature with glowing wings — materializes beside Riya, prepared to protect.

ZEPHYR

The way forward is watched. But the key is within her.

Riya steps forward and begins to solve the puzzle, her fingers glowing as they touch the ancient stones. Her emotions — anger, longing, fear — pulse through the symbols.

FINN

(softly)

You don't just want answers.

You want to matter.

Riya finishes the puzzle. The door creaks open — revealing a glowing chamber and a pedestal with a mirror artifact inside.

INT. ARTIFACT CHAMBER – CONTINUOUS

As Riya steps forward, LYRA enters behind them, blade drawn, face expressionless.

LYRA

You were always meant to lead us here.

Zephyr lunges at her, but Lyra counters skillfully. A fierce skirmish begins. During the fight, the mirror flashes — showing Riya's parents in chains.

Riya screams — magic surging. The chamber shakes. The artifact glows — but cracks slightly.

Finn helps Riya up. Lyra pauses, clearly affected.

LYRA

(softly, to herself)
They lied to me too...

EPISODE TITLE: "Echoes of the Past"

Season 1, Episode 1
ACT 3

INT. ARTIFACT CHAMBER – MOMENTS LATER

Dust settles. Riya helps Zephyr up. Lyra stands across from them, breathing heavily, her blade still drawn — but her face conflicted.

FINN

Go ahead. Strike. That's what you're here for, right?

LYRA

...No. Not anymore.

She tosses the blade aside. Riya and Finn glance at each other, confused.

LYRA

They told me I was chosen. That I'd rise if I helped them.
But they never said anything about the children.
About... you.

She kneels, opens her palm, and reveals a Syndicate sigil. It burns away in blue fire — a quiet act of rebellion.

EXT. DERELICT TOWER – NIGHT

The trio returns to Silas's safehouse. The artifact is stored in a protective chamber. Silas, shocked to see Lyra, tries to attack her — but Riya stops him.

RIYA

She saved us. For now.
But that artifact... it's dangerous. It cracked.

SILAS

It was a mirror of the soul. Only those with clarity can wield it.
Your doubt... it weakened it.

Riya lowers her head — ashamed.

INT. SAFEHOUSE – LATER THAT NIGHT

Riya sits alone, flipping through the journal. She finds a pressed note in the back — a message from Elara and Jaxon, written in ancient script. Zephyr translates.

ZEPHYR

"The child born of fire and light must walk the path of shadows to see her strength."
"When in doubt, trust your heart... and those who walk beside you."

Riya closes the book and looks at her reflection in the cracked mirror.

INT. CITY PALACE – SECRET THRONE ROOM – SAME NIGHT

Inside a hidden sanctum, the wizard king — MALGARETH — stands over a dark pool. He watches Riya and the others through shadowy reflections.

A hunched, undead servant crawls beside him.

SERVANT

The girl lives... and the traitor has turned.

MALGARETH

Then burn her bridge. And open the gate.
The Vein awakens. Soon... my army will rise.

EXT. BLACK MARKET – DAWN

Finn and Riya walk through the market district — Lyra has gone ahead to scout.

They see a familiar-looking merchant selling “artifacts.” Riya notices something — one of them is fake... but identical to the one they found.

RIYA

He’s flooding the city with replicas.
The real one’s worthless if he gets the source.

INT. MARKET SQUARE – MOMENTS LATER

Lyra arrives, dressed in Syndicate garb again, pretending to be loyal. She enters the backroom of the market... and switches the real artifact with the fake one.

A Syndicate agent watches her — suspicious.

EXT. MARKET – ROOFTOPS – CONTINUOUS

Lyra meets up with Riya and Finn — hands them the fake, wrapped tightly.

LYRA

Go. Hide it where they'll find it.

She turns to face the Syndicate agents closing in.

INT. MARKET BACKROOM – SECONDS LATER

Lyra is cornered by MALGARETH'S enforcers. They reveal they knew she turned. There's a brutal fight — Lyra holds them off long enough to destroy the real artifact.

But she's stabbed fatally. Blood runs down her hand as she smiles, victorious.

LYRA (weakly)

...Not your puppet anymore.

She dies with a peaceful expression.

EXT. HILL OVERLOOKING AETHELBURG – SUNSET

Riya and Finn watch the city glow beneath a crimson sky. Zephyr rests beside them, somber.

FINN

She gave everything... for us.

RIYA

Then we finish what she started.

Behind them, the wind shifts. A rumble echoes from the mountains — a dark portal starts to form far off.

FINAL SHOT:

Inside the portal: ghostly soldiers stir... and the wizard king smiles.

EPISODE 2: "The Vein's Whisper"*

Act Structure: *Expands the world, deepens Riya's powers, and introduces the Vein of Eternity as a sentient force.*

ACT 1

Cold Open:

- **EXT. MOUNTAIN PASS – NIGHT**

A hooded figure (later revealed as **Kael**, a rogue Syndicate mage) flees through a blizzard, clutching a glowing shard of the Vein. Shadowy **Revenants** (undead Syndicate enforcers) pursue him.

- The shard **whispers** in a distorted voice: *"Find the spark-bearer..."*

- Kael is cornered — the Revenants raise blades — when **Zephyr's shadow** swoops in.

SMASH CUT TO:

INT. SAFEHOUSE – DAWN

- Riya wakes from a **shared vision** with Zephyr (now in his dragon-cat form), gasping. The cracked mirror artifact shows her **Kael's face**.

- Finn and Silas argue over Lyra's death. Silas reveals the Syndicate is **hunting "spark-bearers"*** — those born with innate magic tied to the Vein.

- **Finn:** *"So Riya's basically a walking target?"*

- **Silas:** *"And a weapon. If Margareth gets her power, the Vein will obey him."*

- Riya touches the mirror — it **shows her mother** in a cell, alive but weakened. She **vows to rescue her**.

EXT. DOCKS – MIDDAY

- The group tracks Kael to a smuggler's ship. Riya uses her magic to **reanimate a broken compass** (first display of her **"awakening" power**).

- They find Kael wounded, hiding in the hull. He's **cynical, traumatized**, and doesn't trust Riya — until Zephyr **speaks in his mind**, revealing Riya is Elara's daughter.

- **Kael:** **"Then you're the reason the Syndicate killed my family."* (He blames Elara for opposing Margareth and painting targets on spark-bearers.)

ACT 2

INT. DOCKS – SMUGGLER'S TUNNELS

- Revenants attack. A chase ensues — Riya's magic **unconsciously manipulates water** (teasing her elemental affinity). Kael fights beside them, using **smoke-based illusions**.

- **Finn:** **"You're Syndicate. Why help us?"*

- **Kael:** **"Because the Vein showed me what Margareth really is. And it's worse than a tyrant."*

EXT. ABANDONED LIGHTHOUSE – NIGHT

- Kael reveals the shard's vision: Margareth is **hollowing out the Vein**, turning it into a weapon. The group debates:

- **Silas** wants to destroy the shard.

- **Riya** insists on using it to find her mother.

- **Finn** notices the shard's glow **pulses toward Riya** like a heartbeat.

- Zephyr warns that the Vein is **alive** — and it's **choosing Riya**.

INT. SYNDICATE STRONGHOLD – FLASHBACK

- Through the shard, Riya sees **Elara in chains**, whispering to another prisoner: **"Tell Riya... the Vein remembers."*

EXT. LIGHTHOUSE – MIDNIGHT

- Revenants ambush them. Kael sacrifices himself to buy time, handing Riya the shard. As he dies, he **smiles**: **"Don't let it lie to you like it lied to me."*

- Riya **absorbs the shard's power** in a burst of light. Her eyes glow violet — she **hears the Vein's voice**: **"Free me."*

ACT 3

EXT. COASTAL CLIFFS – DAWN

- The group escapes, but Riya is **changed**. Her magic now leaves **cracked, glowing scars** on her skin when she uses it.

- Finn confronts her: **"You're hiding something."*

- Riya admits the Vein showed her **a path underground** — to where her mother is held. But it requires **blood magic** (a taboo).

- **Zephyr:** **"The Vein is desperate. It will twist the truth to survive."*

INT. SYNDICATE DUNGEONS – MARGARETH'S SANCTUM

- Malgareth stands over a **chained, ghostly figure** (the **Vein's avatar**). He extracts its essence into a black orb.

- **Malgareth:** "Soon, even the spark-bearers will kneel."

EXT. HIDDEN CAVE – NIGHT

- Riya prepares to perform the blood ritual. Finn tries to stop her, but Silas surprisingly **supports her**:

- **Silas:** "Sometimes the only way out is through the dark."

- The ritual works — a tunnel opens. But as they enter, the walls **bleed black liquid**. The Vein whispers: "You're mine now."

FINAL SHOT:

- The camera pulls back to reveal the tunnel is **inside a massive, fossilized dragon's ribcage** — the **true source** of the Vein.

POST-CREDIT STING:

- A hooded figure (**Elara?**) touches the same dragon bones elsewhere, whispering: "She's coming."

EPISODE 2 THEMES & SETUP FOR EPISODE 3:

- **Power & Corruption:** Riya's magic is evolving, but at a cost.

- **The Vein's Agenda:** Is it a victim or a manipulator?

- **Next Episode:** The dragon's skeleton holds secrets about Zephyr's true form and Malgareth's past.

Would you like **dialogue snippets**, a **script polish**, or a **shift to Episode 3's outline**?

(Or if you'd prefer, I can adapt this into a **screenplay format** with visual direction for animation!)

Here's **Episode 3** of *Riya: Shadows of Aethelburg*, titled **"Bone of the Forgotten"**, diving into the dragon's skeleton, Zephyr's origins, and Malgareth's twisted past.

EPISODE 3: "Bone of the Forgotten"

Themes: *Identity, Sacrifice, and the Cost of Power*

ACT 1

Cold Open:

- **EXT. ANCIENT BATTLEFIELD – FLASHBACK (DUSK)**

A colossal **dragon (Aetherion)** battles a hooded sorcerer (young **Malgareth**). The dragon is impaled by a spike of black crystal — but with its dying breath, it **splits its soul**:

- One half becomes the **Vein of Eternity** (the magic source).
- The other half **condenses into Zephyr**, who flees as a tiny hatchling.
- **MATCH CUT TO:**

INT. FOSSILIZED DRAGON'S RIB-CAGE – PRESENT

- Riya, Finn, and Silas step into the cavernous skeleton. The air hums with residual magic.

Black veins pulse in the walls.

- Riya's scars **glow sympathetically**. She hears whispers: *"You carry my child's spark."*

- **Zephyr freezes**. For the first time, he **remembers**: *"I was... part of this."*

EXT. CLIFFS ABOVE THE CAVE – DAY

- Syndicate scouts (led by **Vexis**, a ruthless tracker with mechanical wings) spot the entrance. Vexis sends a Revenant to report to Malgareth.

INT. DRAGON'S HEART-CHAMBER

- The group finds a **crystallized heart**, cracked and oozing black mist. Riya touches it —

visions flood her mind:

- **Malgareth** was once a scholar, corrupted by the dragon's power.
- **Elara** was his apprentice before she betrayed him.
- The **Vein** is screaming, trapped between life and death.
- **Silas warns them**: *"This place is a wound. It's why magic is dying."*

ACT 2

INT. SYNDICATE FORTRESS – MALGARETH'S LAB

- Malgareth examines **Elara's comatose body** in a glass tube. He murmurs: *"Your daughter has your stubbornness. And your weakness."*

- A Revenant arrives, reporting Riya's location. Malgareth smiles: *"Let her awaken the heart. Then I'll cut it out."*

INT. DRAGON'S SKULL – NIGHT

- Finn discovers **carved runes** — a ritual to "restore" the Vein. But Silas realizes it requires a **living sacrifice**.

- **Finn**: *"Absolutely not. We're not feeding Riya to a corpse!"*

- **Zephyr**: *"Not her. Me."*

- Riya refuses, but Zephyr reveals the truth: *"I'm a shadow of Aetherion. If I return, the Vein might heal."*

- **Argument escalates** — Riya's magic flares, **cracking the heart further**. Black tendrils lash out, knocking Finn aside.

****EXT. CAVE ENTRANCE – VEXIS' AMBUSH****

- Syndicate forces attack. Silas stays behind to hold them off, **using forbidden blood magic** to collapse the tunnel.

- **Silas (grinning):** "Tell my brother... I finally outdid him." (Reveal: Silas is Malgareth's sibling.)

- Riya and Finn race deeper, pursued by Vexis.

**ACT 3**

****INT. HEART-CHAMBER – FINAL CONFRONTATION****

- Zephyr **expands to full dragon size** (briefly) to fight Vexis, but he's too weak. Vexis **severs his connection to the Vein**, shrinking him back to a frail hatchling.

- Riya, enraged, **unleashes uncontrolled magic** — but it accelerates the corruption. The cave begins to collapse.

- **Finn grabs the ritual knife:** "You're not the only one who can sacrifice, Riya." He moves to stab himself—

****LAST-MINUTE TWIST:****

- **Elara's voice echoes** through the cavern: "The Vein doesn't want death. It wants remembrance."

- Riya **does the opposite of the ritual** — instead of offering blood, she **gives the Vein her memories** of her parents, Zephyr, Finn. The heart **shudders**, then **cleanses**, pushing back the corruption.

- Vexis, exposed to the purified magic, **screams as her mechanical wings disintegrate**. She flees.

****EPILOGUE:****

****EXT. MOUNTAINS – DAWN****

The group emerges. The land is **slightly greener**, magic humming stronger. But Riya **can't remember Finn's name**.

- **Zephyr (softly):** "The Vein took her memories... but not forever."

****POST-CREDIT STING:****

Malgareth **injects himself with black Vein essence**, mutating into a **dragon-like monstrosity**.